

Global Precious Metals Comment

Precious metals navigate no-man's land for now

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Global

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Downside risks to our views have increased materially

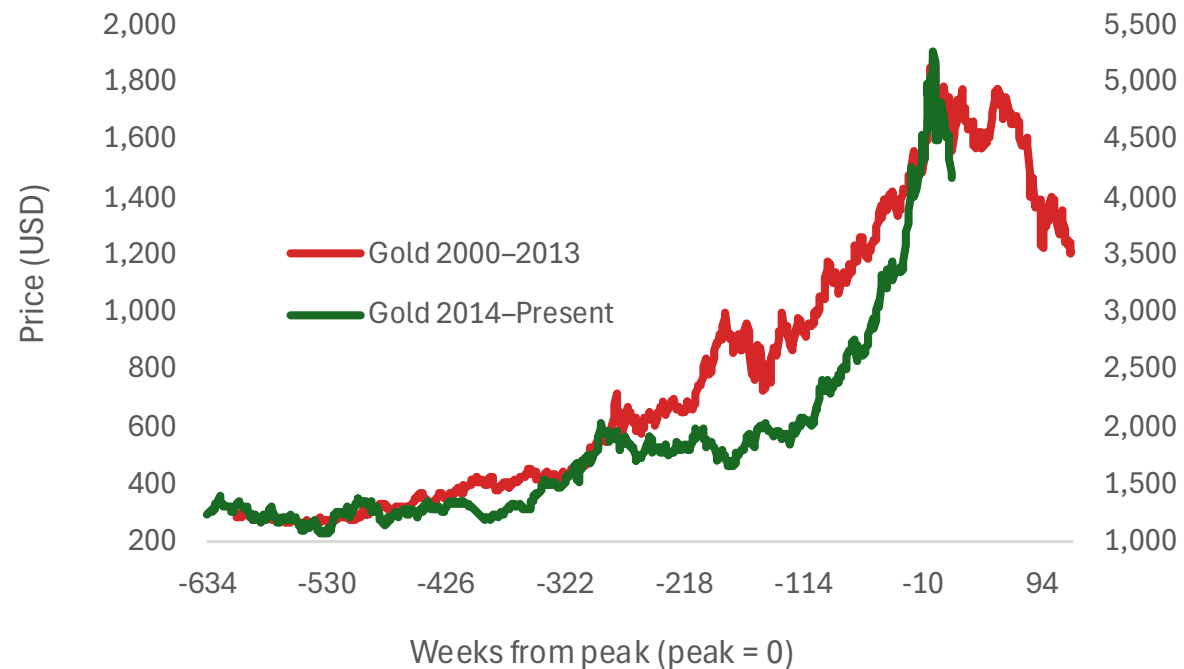
Gold has come under immense pressure as yields have risen further and the market continues to anticipate rate hikes. While there are some echoes to the previous bear market in gold, we think ultimately this time is different. We continue to see higher gold prices ahead as we expect the Fed to resume easing policy rates and as diversification trends both in the private as well as official sector continues. That said, timelines of our expected price forecast profile may be pushed out, with greater uncertainty on how long the current consolidation might extend. Economic data prints out of the US will be a key focus in the coming months, with any signs of softening likely to encourage re-engagement in gold. For now, summer trading conditions are likely to continue.

White precious metals remain highly correlated with gold, but demand headwinds lie ahead

There's risk that slower growth would weigh on demand for the more industrial precious metals. Silver may have attractive overall demand prospects over the long term given its exposure to AI, renewable energy and electric vehicles, but for now any slowdown in industrial demand is likely to be a headwind. We think this will manifest more in silver's relative performance to gold, rather than its overall price direction i.e. the gold:silver ratio is likely to struggle to revisit previous lows. Platinum and palladium are both vulnerable to weaker auto demand. But silver and platinum have more potential to attract investor flows in a rising gold price environment. Meanwhile palladium continues to be challenged by increasing market share of battery electric vehicles, especially as China's exports of more affordable models continue to rise.

Is the market capitulating?

Comparing gold bull/bear markets



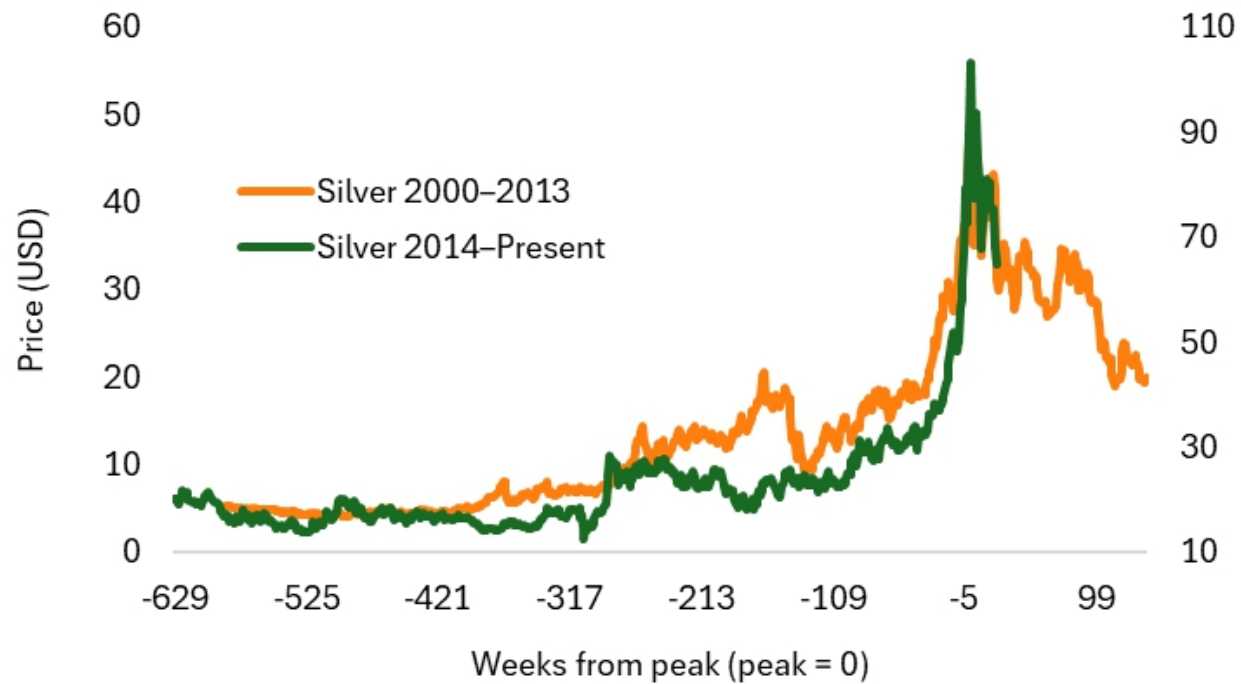
Source: Bloomberg, UBS



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Is the market capitulating?

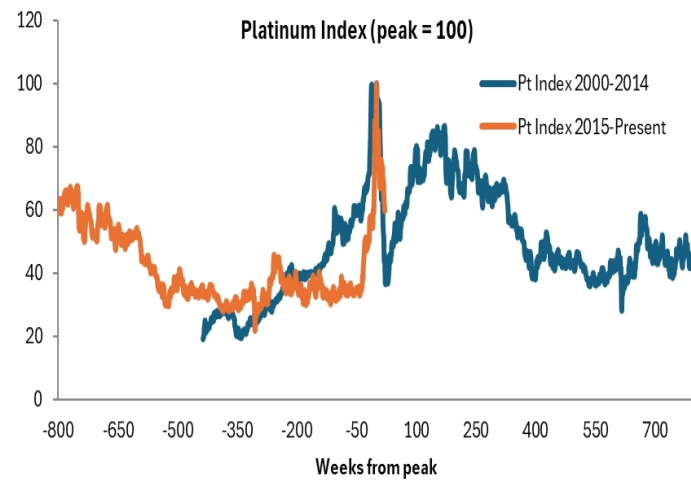
Comparing silver bull/bear markets



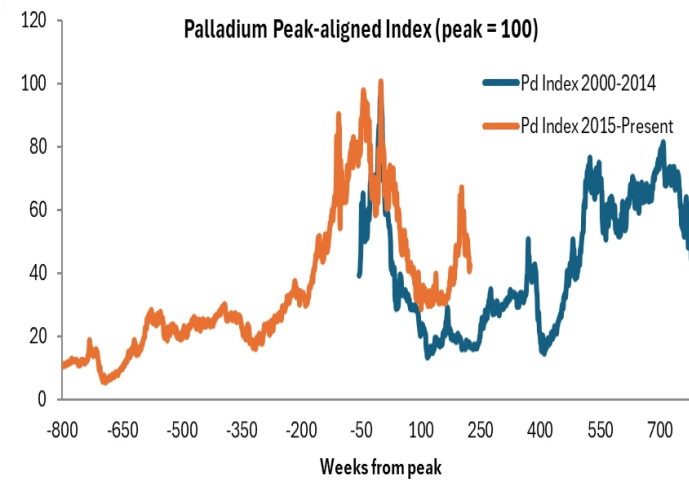
Source: Bloomberg, UBS



Is the market capitulating?



Source: Bloomberg, UBS

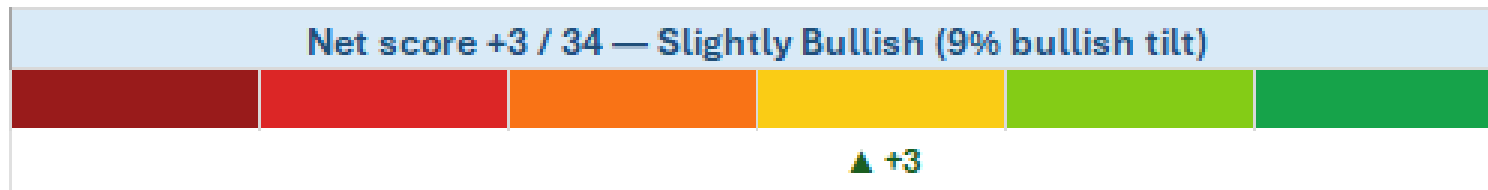


Source: Bloomberg, UBS



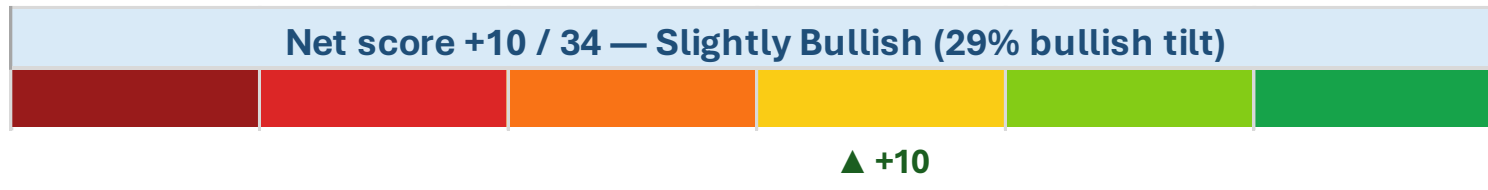
There are challenges in the short run

Current sentiment scorecard



Source: UBS

Sentiment scorecard in May



Source: UBS



Underlying factors remain supportive

	2013	YTD 2026
Gold Price (\$/oz)	↓ -29%	↑ +1.2% YTD
Catalyst for gold weakness	Monetary policy regime shift; fear of central bank selling (Cyprus)	Stretched positions unwinding (Jan/Feb); Oil shock fuelling inflation and rate hike expectations; stronger USD & higher real yields; fear of central bank selling
USD Index (BBDXY)	↑ stronger (+3% full year; +7% to peak)	→ choppy (+1.17% YTD; +4% trough to peak)
CPI Inflation (% YoY)	↓ Falling (2.0% → 1.0%)	↑ Rising (2.7% → 4.2%)
Real Yields (10Y TIPS %)	↑ Turned positive (major headwind)	↑ Rising (+27bp net YTD; +54bp trough to peak)
Fed Funds Rate (%)	→ Held at 0.25%; Taper announced	→ Held at 3.75%; market pricing in 1.7 hikes by yearend
Fed Monetary Policy Stance	→ Shifting from accommodation to normalization	→ Pause after 175bp of cuts; watching 2-sided risks
US GDP Growth (%)	→ Moderate (2.1-2.5%)	→ Holding (2.8% → 2.6%)
US Unemployment Rate (%)	↓ Falling (8.1% → 6.2%)	↑ Rising (3.9% → 4.3%)
US Fiscal Deficit/GDP (%)	↑ Improving (-6.5% → -2.7%)	↑ Improving but at a wider gap (-6.9% → -5.95%)
US Debt/GDP (%)	→ Stable (~104%)	→ Elevated, stable (~137%)
US Credit Rating	→ Stable (post-2011 downgrade)	→ Stable but under pressure
Financial Conditions Index	↑ Easing (-1.1 → +1.0)	↑ Volatile but generally easing (-1.2 → +1.14)
S&P 500 P/E Ratio	↑ Rising (14-15x → 16-17x)	→ Choppy and elevated (range 24-28x)
VIX Volatility	→ Low/moderate (avg 13-15)	↑ Easing (avg 19; peak 31)
Commodities (BCOM Index)	↓ -11.6%	↑ +15% YTD, though off the highs
Bond Market	↑ Yields surging (taper tantrum); US10y +127bp net	↑ Rising, US10y +0.32bp net YTD, +73bp trough to peak
Geopolitical Risks	→ Regional tensions (China-Japan tensions over disputed islands; Syria conflict)	↑ Elevated global tensions (Middle East conflict, Russia/Ukraine war, US trade/tariff wars)
Macroeconomic Narrative	Improving fundamentals; reduced safe-haven demand	Elevated macro & geopolitical uncertainty; risks to growth-inflation mix persist

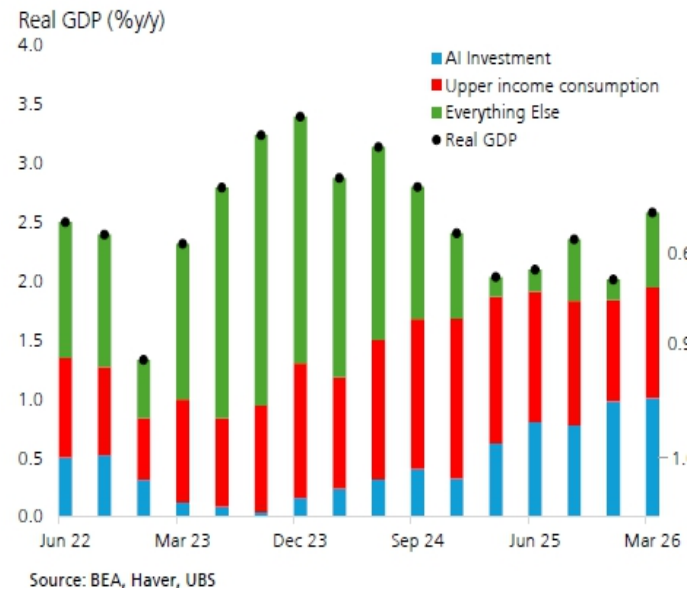
Source: Bloomberg, UBS



US economic data held up by AI

AI and tech are driving the strength in investment and likely supporting upper income households' consumption. AI-reliance implies vulnerabilities, but productivity gains present downside risks to gold.

Our house view remains for Fed rate cuts from 2027



Variable	2023	2024	2025	2026	2027	2028
Change in real GDP	3.4	2.4	2.0	2.1	2.1	2.6
Unemployment rate	3.8	4.2	4.5	4.5	4.5	4.4
PCE inflation	2.9	2.6	2.8	3.3	2.2	1.9
Core PCE inflation	3.3	3.0	2.9	3.1	2.4	2.0
Federal funds rate	5.4	4.4	3.6	3.6	2.9	2.9

Note: Q4/Q4 % basis except the unemployment rate which is a Q4 quarterly average. The federal funds rate reflects the mid-point of the target range. Years after 2025 are forecasts.

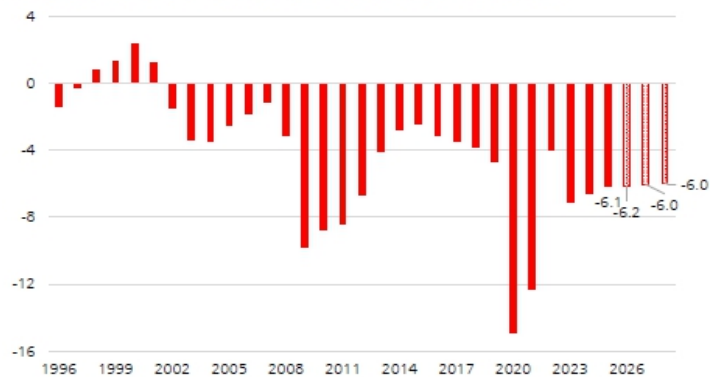
Source: BEA, BLS, Haver, UBS



US debt sustainability remains a long-term concern

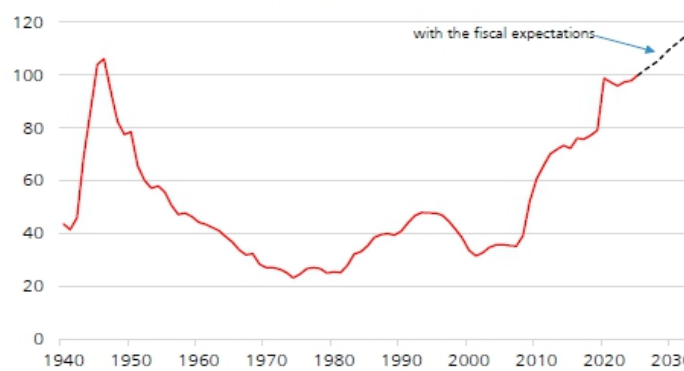
US debt held by the public over 100% of GDP – significantly higher than other sovereigns with AA+ rating

Budget deficit adjusted for student loan accounting (FY, % of GDP)



Source: CBO, Haver, UBS

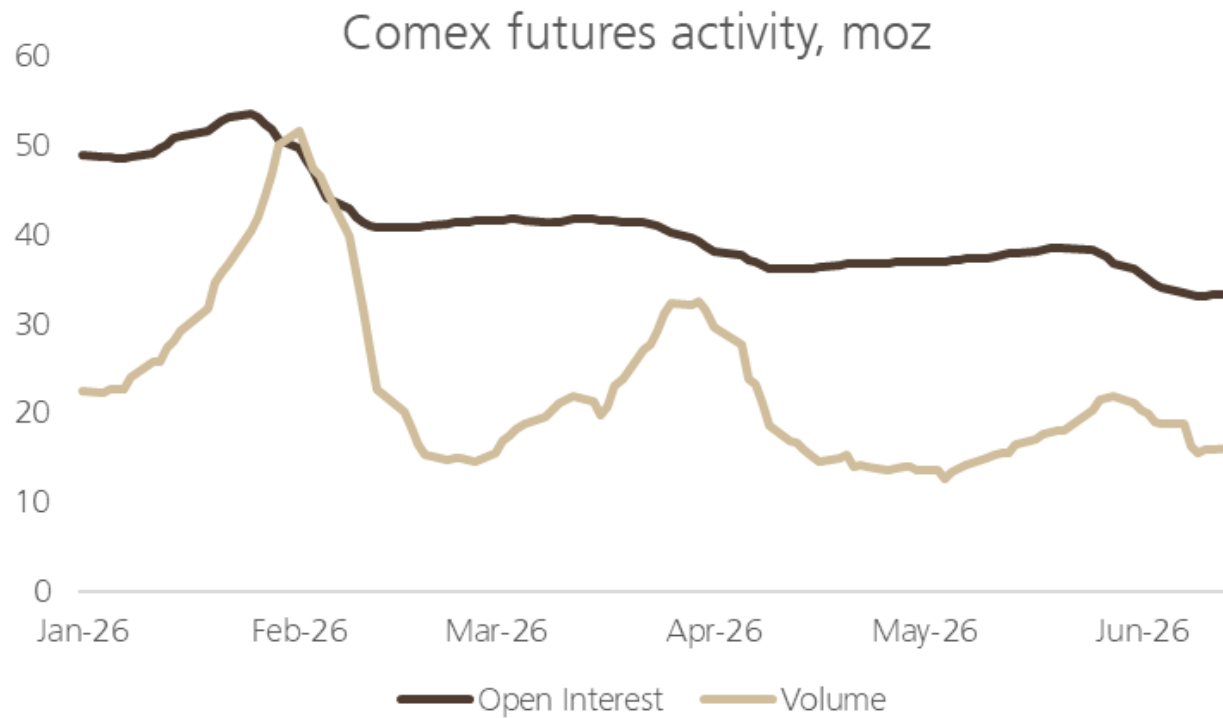
Debt Held by the Public as a Percentage of GDP (Fiscal Yr, %)



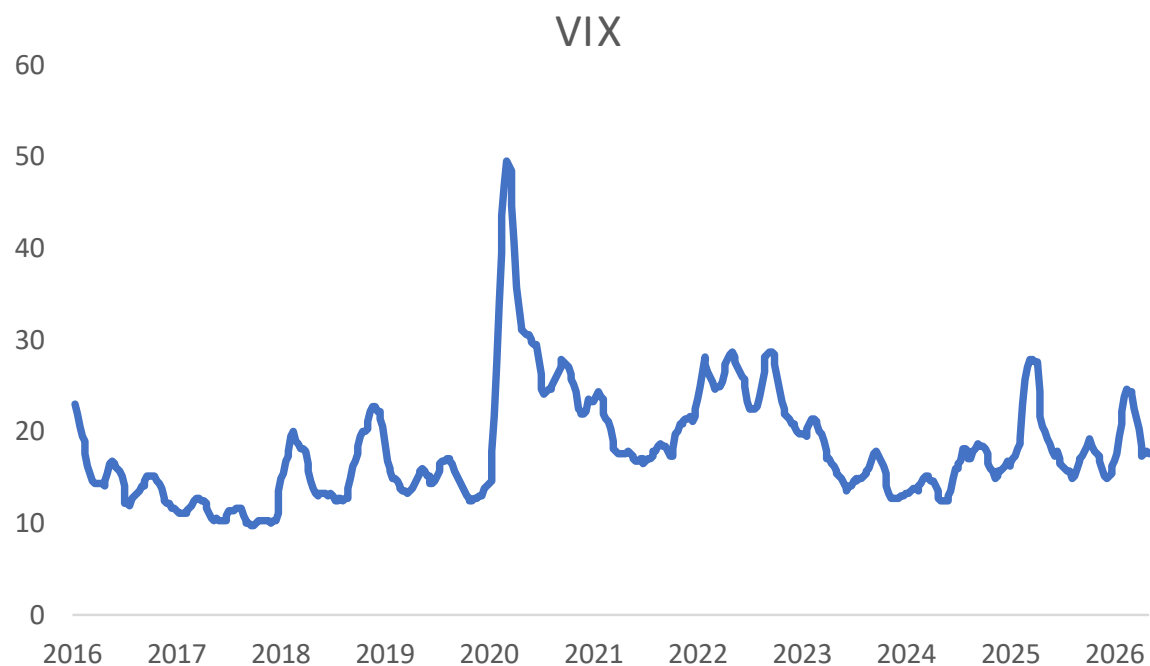
Source: U.S. Treasury, Haver, UBS



Summer has come



Volatility has come down

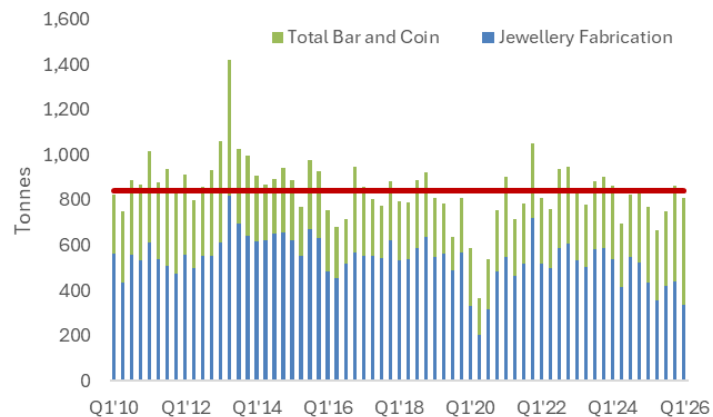


Source: Bloomberg, UBS



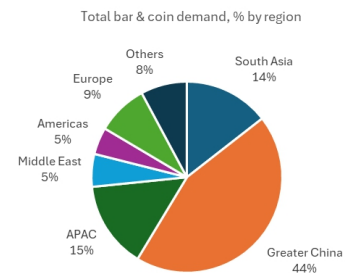
Physical demand supported by investment

Total physical demand has held up despite record high prices



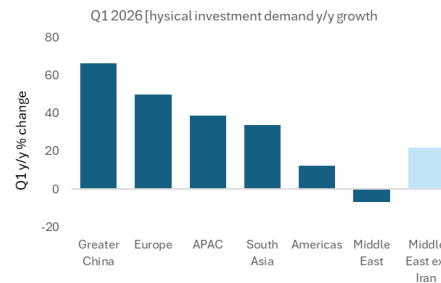
Source: WGC, UBS

Asia accounts for over 70% of physical investment demand



Source: WGC, UBS

Strong growth seen across most regions

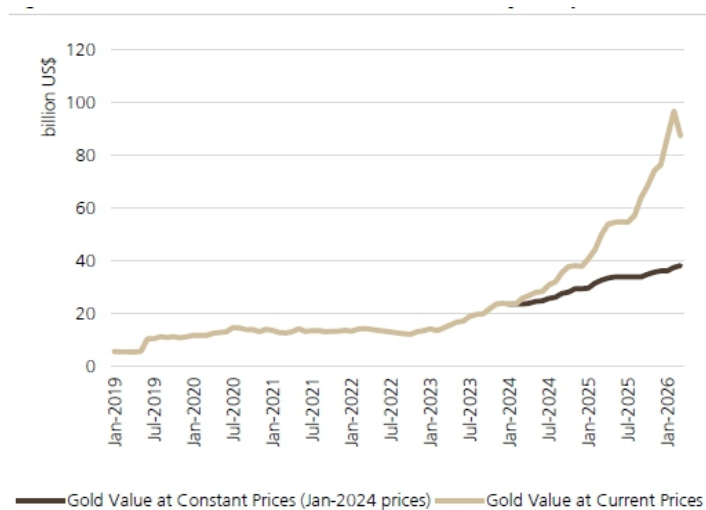


Source: WGC, UBS



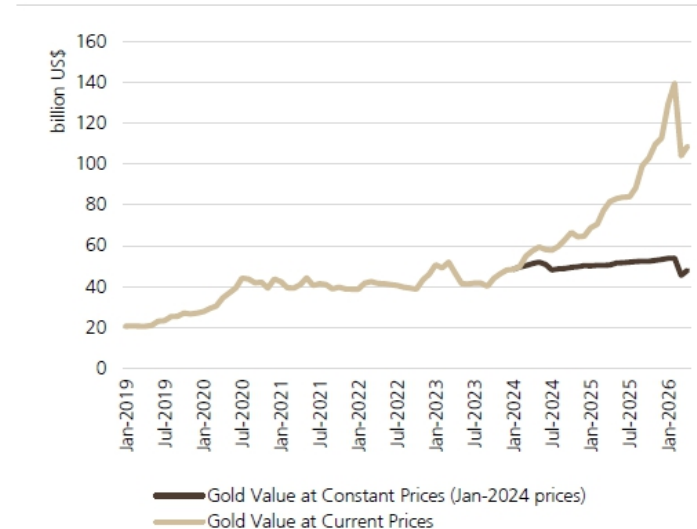
Official gold reserves are misunderstood

Poland's gold reserves USD value



Source: IMF, Haver, UBS

Turkey's gold reserves USD value

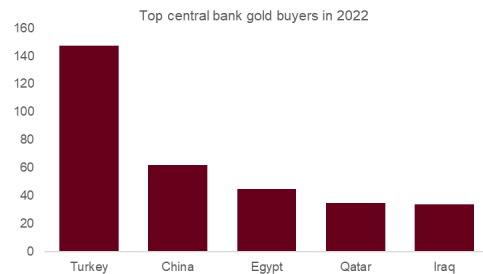


Source: Haver, IMF, UBS



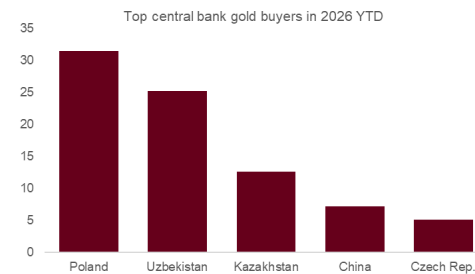
Official sector participation is expanding

The composition of top buyers in 2022...



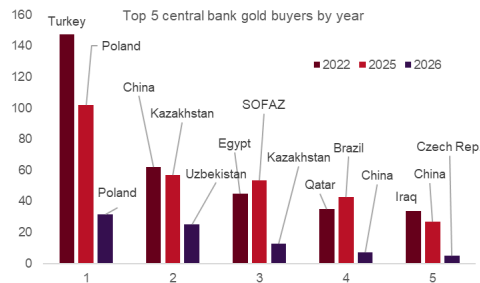
Source: IMF, WGC, UBS

...is different from the top buyers in 2026 YTD



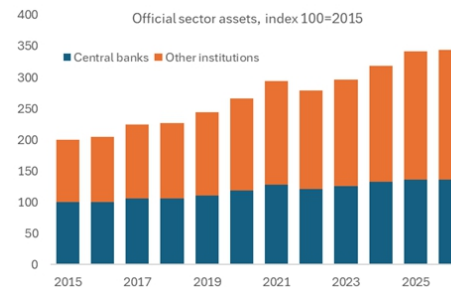
Source: IMF, WGC, UBS

As some central banks slow down purchases, others have room to step up



Source: IMF, WGC, UBS

Growth in assets of other official institutions suggests there is room for them to also diversify into gold

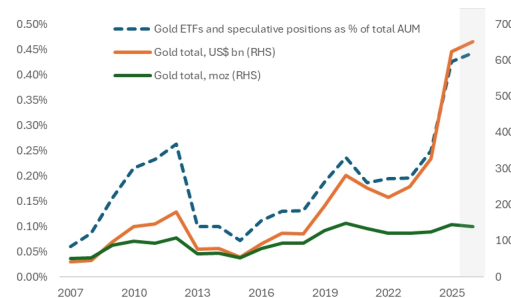


Source: industry estimates, UBS



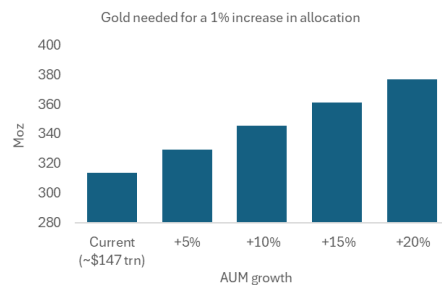
There is room for gold diversification to continue...

We think the market as a whole remains largely underinvested



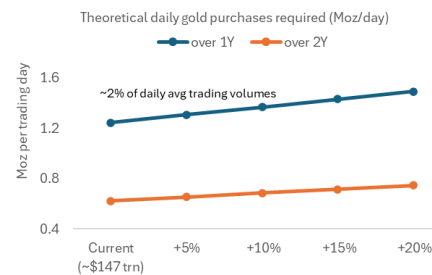
Source: Bloomberg, CFTC, various funds, industry estimates, UBS calculations

Growth in total assets under management creates space for gold diversification



Source: Industry estimates, UBS calculations

The potential impact of a 1% increase in gold allocations depends on the speed & timing of execution



Source: Industry estimates, UBS calculations



...amid a growing list of long-term concerns



Elevated macro
and geopolitical
uncertainty



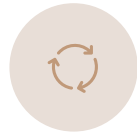
Downside risks to
growth



Upside risks to
inflation



Stagflation risks



De-dollarisation,
asset rotation,
diversification



Shifting global
political and trade
relationships



Fed independence
and credibility



Fiscal and debt
sustainability



Higher volatility
and potential
liquidity issues

Source: UBS



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Downside risks to gold prices



Rebalancing



Sharp equity selloff



Significantly lower central bank purchases/signs of strategic selling



Better-than-expected US growth



Hawkish Fed



Higher real rates, stronger US dollar

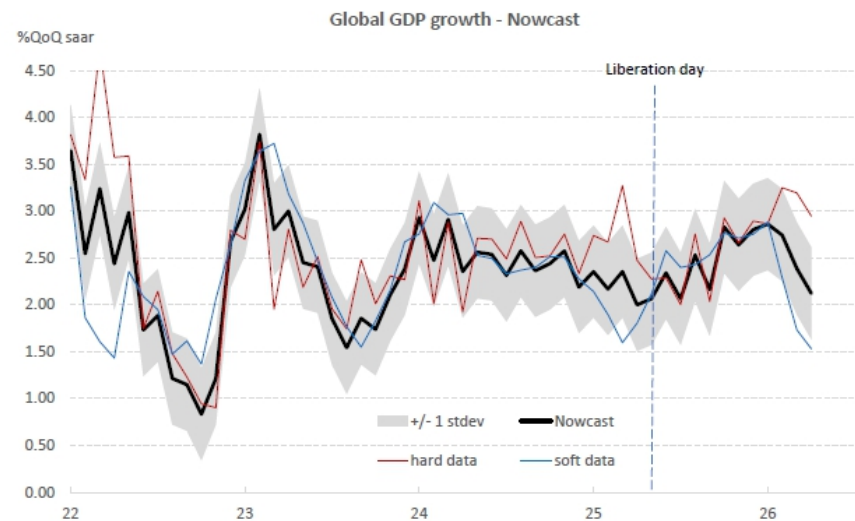
Source: UBS



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White precious metals face demand headwinds

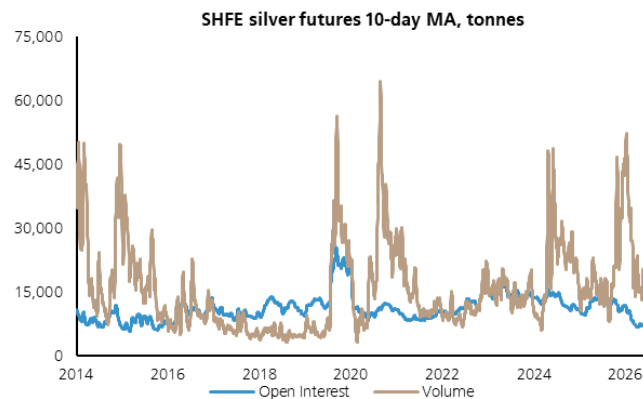
Global median growth swinging down to 2.1% in May



Source: Haver, CEIC, UBS calculations

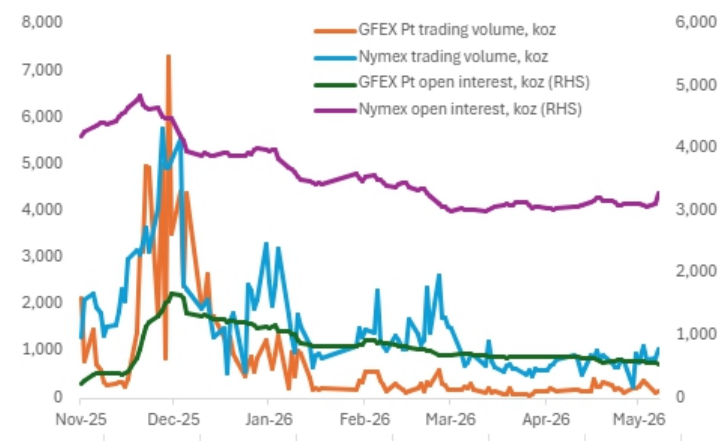
Watch silver and platinum trading in China

Shanghai Futures Exchange silver trading activity



Source: Bloomberg, SHFE, UBS

Guangzhou Futures Exchange platinum trading activity

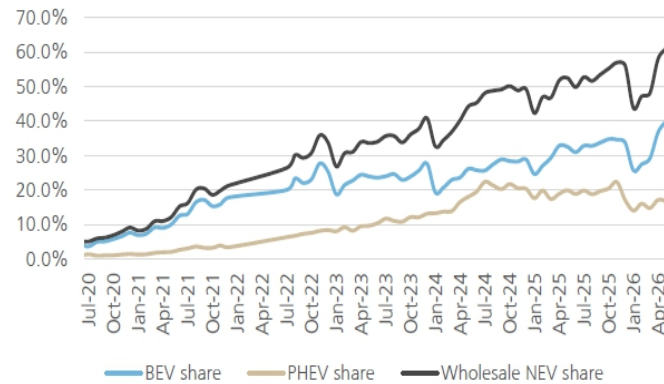


Source: Bloomberg, SHFE, UBS



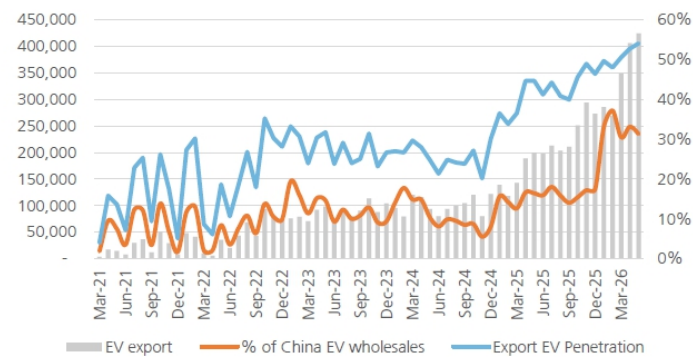
Electric vehicle trends continue to weigh on Pd

EV wholesale penetration in China



Source: CPCA, UBS

China EV export sales (unit)



Source: CPCA, UBS



Risks to our views have increased materially

						new vs old	base case vs	risks to base
		old	base case	upside	downside	forecast	spot	case
Gold	end-2026	5,600	5,600	6,000	3,800	0%	19%	
	end-2027	5,000	5,000	6,000	3,500	0%	6%	
Silver	end-2026	120	120	150	65	0%	38%	
	end-2027	90	90	135	55	0%	4%	
Platinum	end-2026	2,700	2,700	3,000	1,900	0%	28%	
	end-2027	2,500	2,500	3,000	1,675	0%	18%	
Palladium	end-2026	1,900	1,900	2,450	1,400	0%	27%	
	end-2027	1,700	1,700	2,150	1,250	0%	14%	

Source: UBS



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Valuation Method and Risk Statement

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